

Introduce yourself to a person sitting in front, behind or beside you.

What are three insights from the brief, the reading and/or initial secondary research?

What is muddy/unclear from these pre-work activities?

Pair & Share
Insights and/or muddy
points from Week 2
pre-work

IDEA9106 Design Thinking Semester 2 2026



We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities – past, present, and emerging – of the lands that the University of Sydney's campuses stand on. For thousands of years they have shared and exchanged knowledges across innumerable generations for the benefit of all.



Overview: Week 2

- Assessments
- Design Thinking concepts & theory
- Design Thinking methods & practice
- Active learning
- Wrap Up



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A1a. Mindset task

- First reflective practice task has been completed
- Assessments remain open till all submissions are received

Semester-long Project Brief: In the Meantime



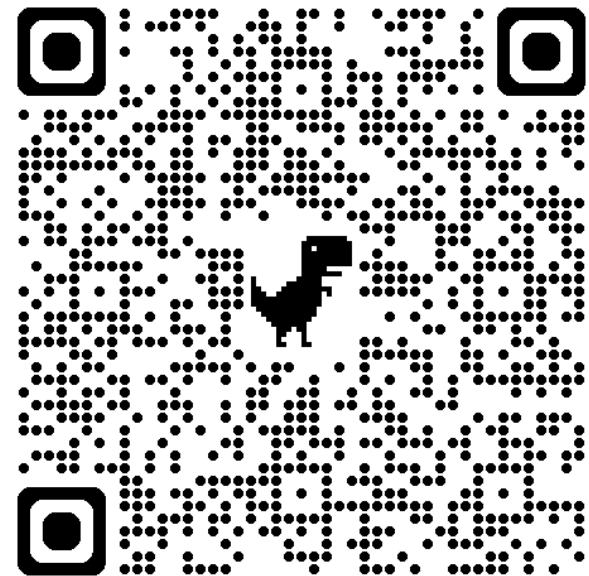
Photo by Earl Andre Roca

Semester-long Project Brief:

In the Meantime

Identify a specific group of people in a specific waiting situation.

Discover and define their problem, develop and prototype a response and deliver the final solution.



Understanding the project brief

- **The domain:** Waiting. Queues you can see, and queues you cannot.
- **The constraint:** Capacity is fixed. You cannot add staff, lanes, servers or stock. Whatever you design works within the capacity that already exists.
- **The response:** It must change the waiting situation, not simply occupy the people in it. No medium is ruled out, including apps that are part of a larger system.
- **The accountability:** Identify at least two stakeholder groups. State who the response is for, who commissions it, and who bears the cost.
- **The team:** Project groups of five students from the same tutorial group, finalised by the end of Week 3.

A3. Context exploration & mapping

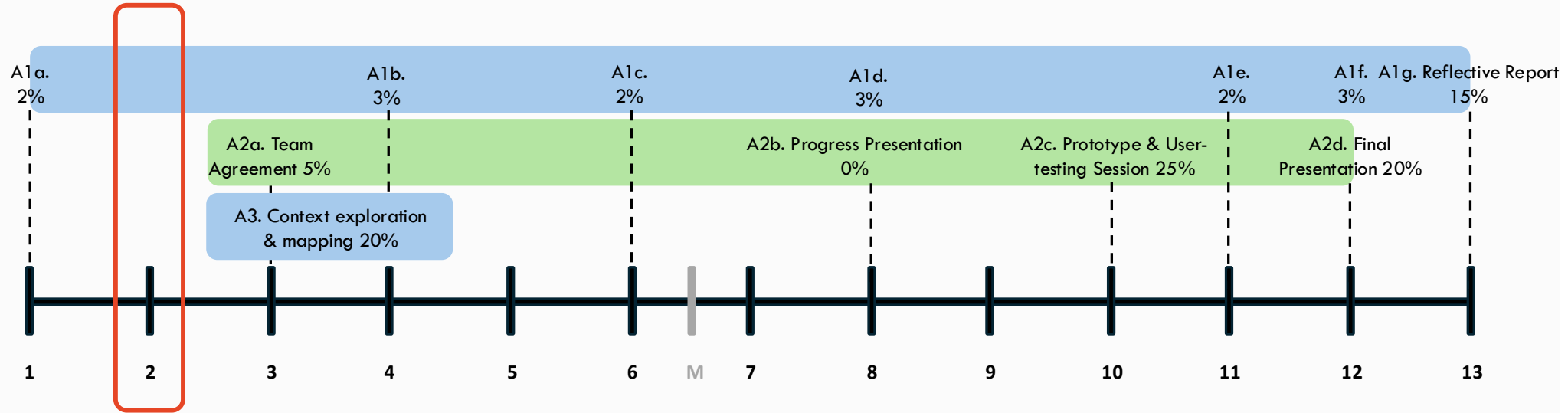
- Each student will individually conduct secondary research (desk research) and primary research (3 user interviews) into waiting: where it happens, who does it, who manages it, and what it costs the people caught in it, guided by the design brief.
- Once A3 has been completed, it will form part of your project group's collective research for the semester-long project.
- We are starting to engage with the brief this week in tutorials with sketchnoting and mapping

IDEA9106 Assessments Semester 1 2026

All assessments are mandatory

Questionati is the unit's AI for 24/7 answers to assessment questions

Assessments in this unit are connected, building towards A1 g. And A2d.



MS: Mindset

PE: Peer & Self evaluation

Individual tasks

Teamwork tasks

A1: Reflective practice

A2: Collaborative learning

A3: Framing and Reframing

Weekly lecture attendance check

- In-person and online attendance, and recorded lecture views are monitored
- Students who attend or watch lecture recordings have a much better understanding of key concepts, and tutorial and assessment requirements
- No mark penalty but you will receive reminder emails about the importance of lectures



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Where will I actually use this?

Questions after last week's lecture:

- Where does design thinking get used in practice?
- How does it advance a career?

Fair question. Design thinking has a credibility problem.

- IDEO, 2023: a third of staff cut, Munich and Tokyo offices closed.
- Natasha Jen, 2017: the method produces post-its and process diagrams. It rarely produces criticism, or judging whether the result is any good.

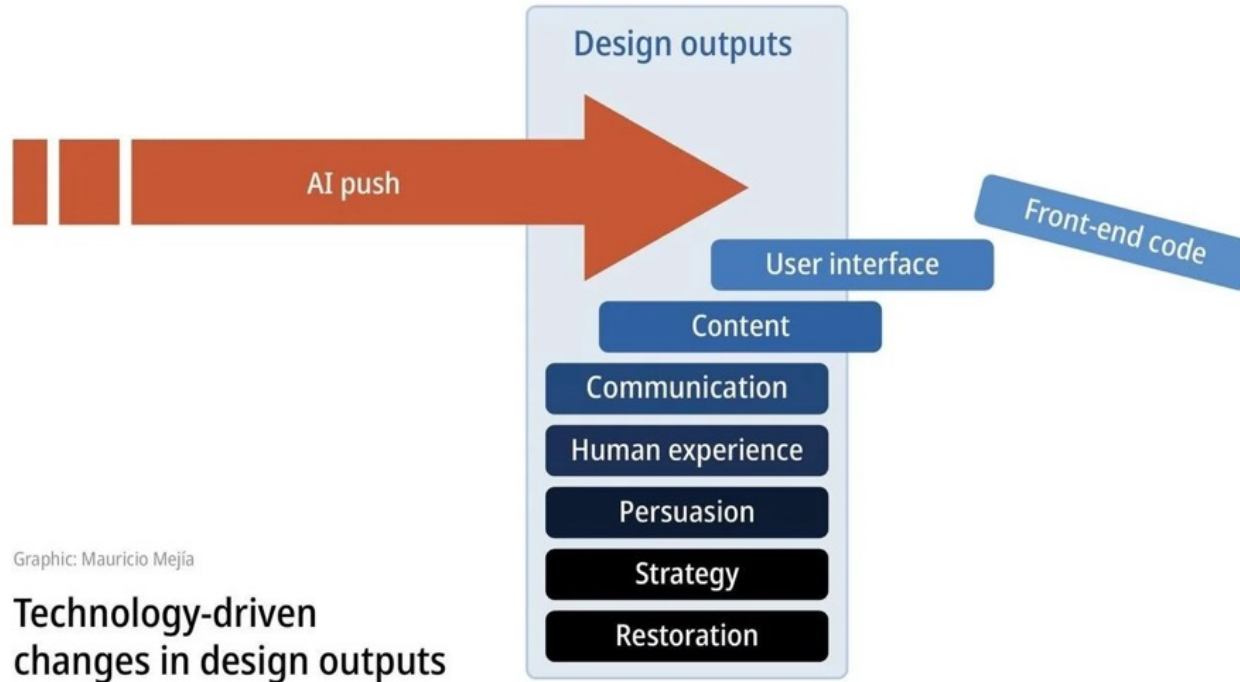
The kit and the capability

The kit: a double diamond, four stages, tools within each stage, visual maps, etc.

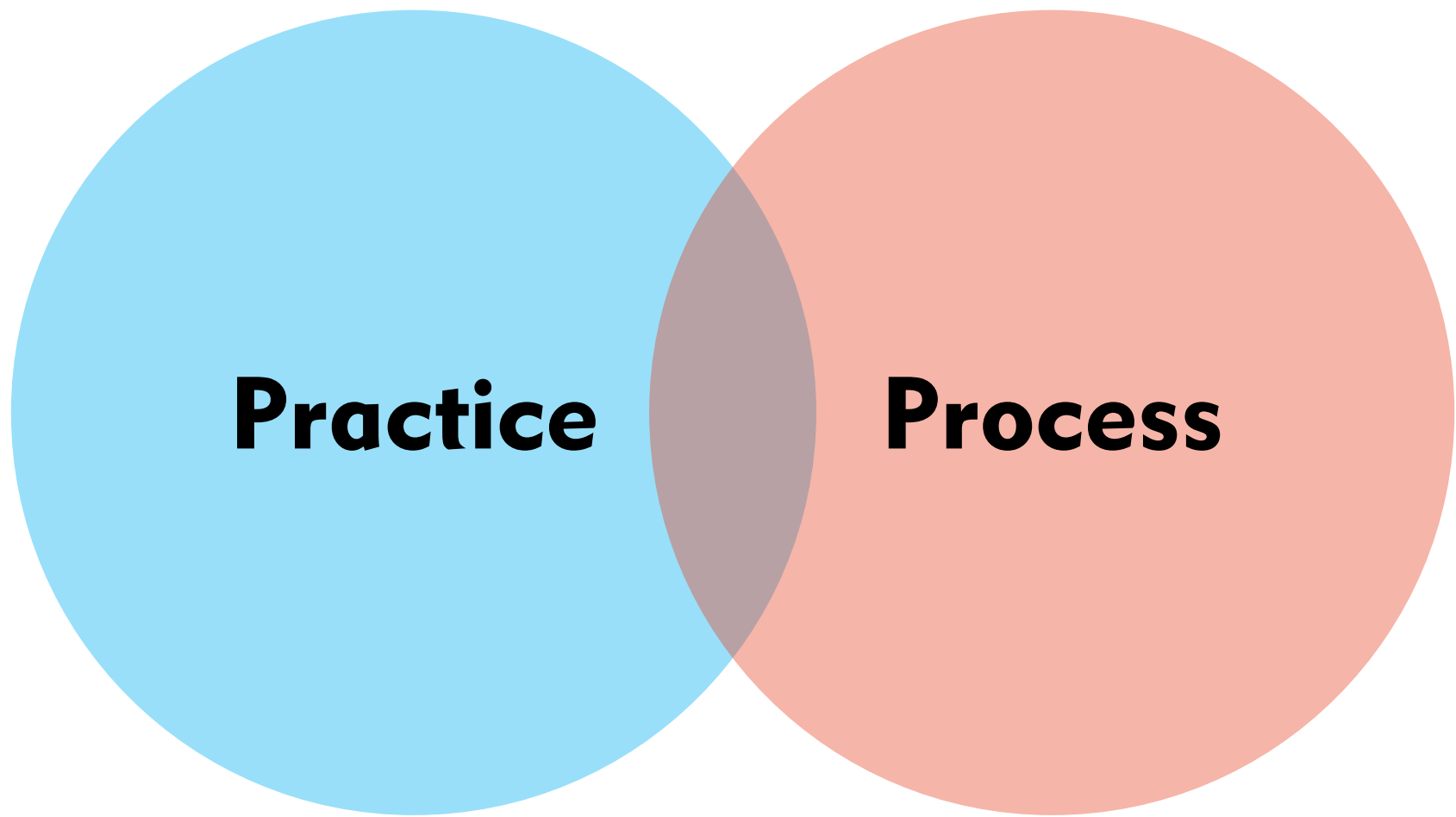
The capability: framing a problem before committing to a solution. Making sense of what you observe. Turning observation into insight. Making something rough enough to be wrong cheaply.

Building solutions keeps getting cheaper.

Building the wrong thing does not.



**Building solutions keeps getting cheaper.
Building the wrong thing does not.**



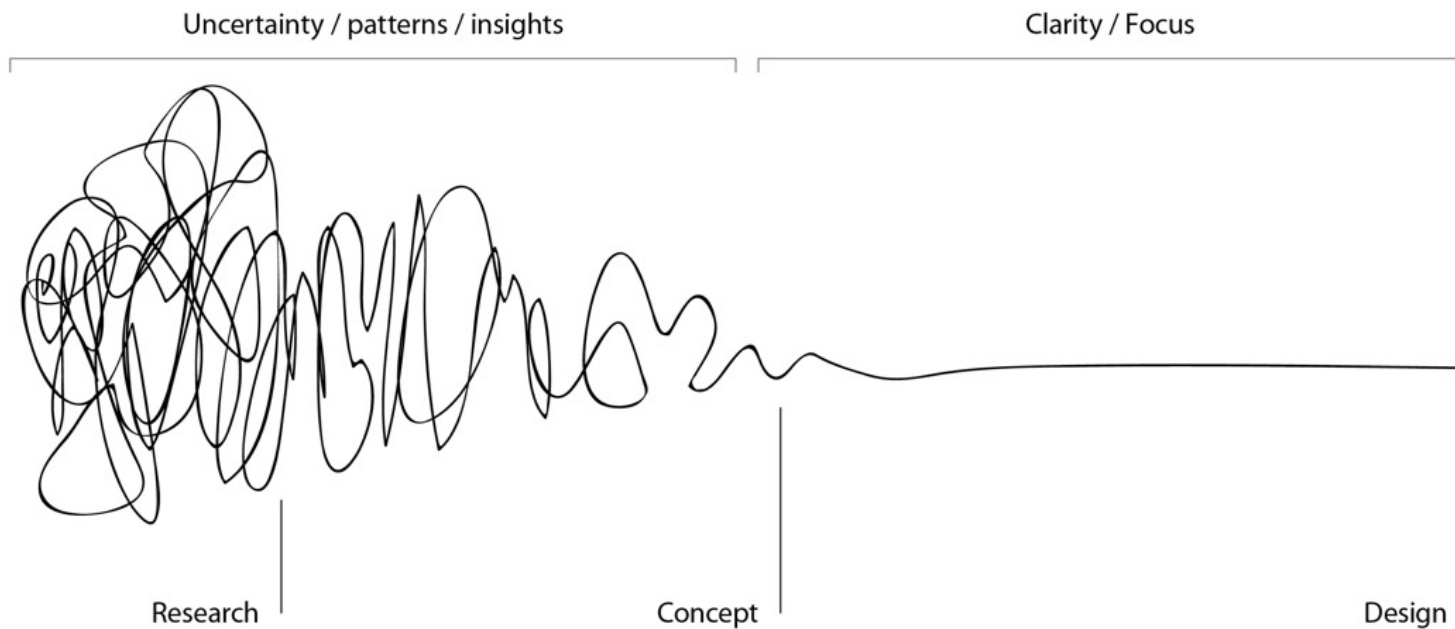
What is design thinking?

Week 1 reading: Luchs (2015)

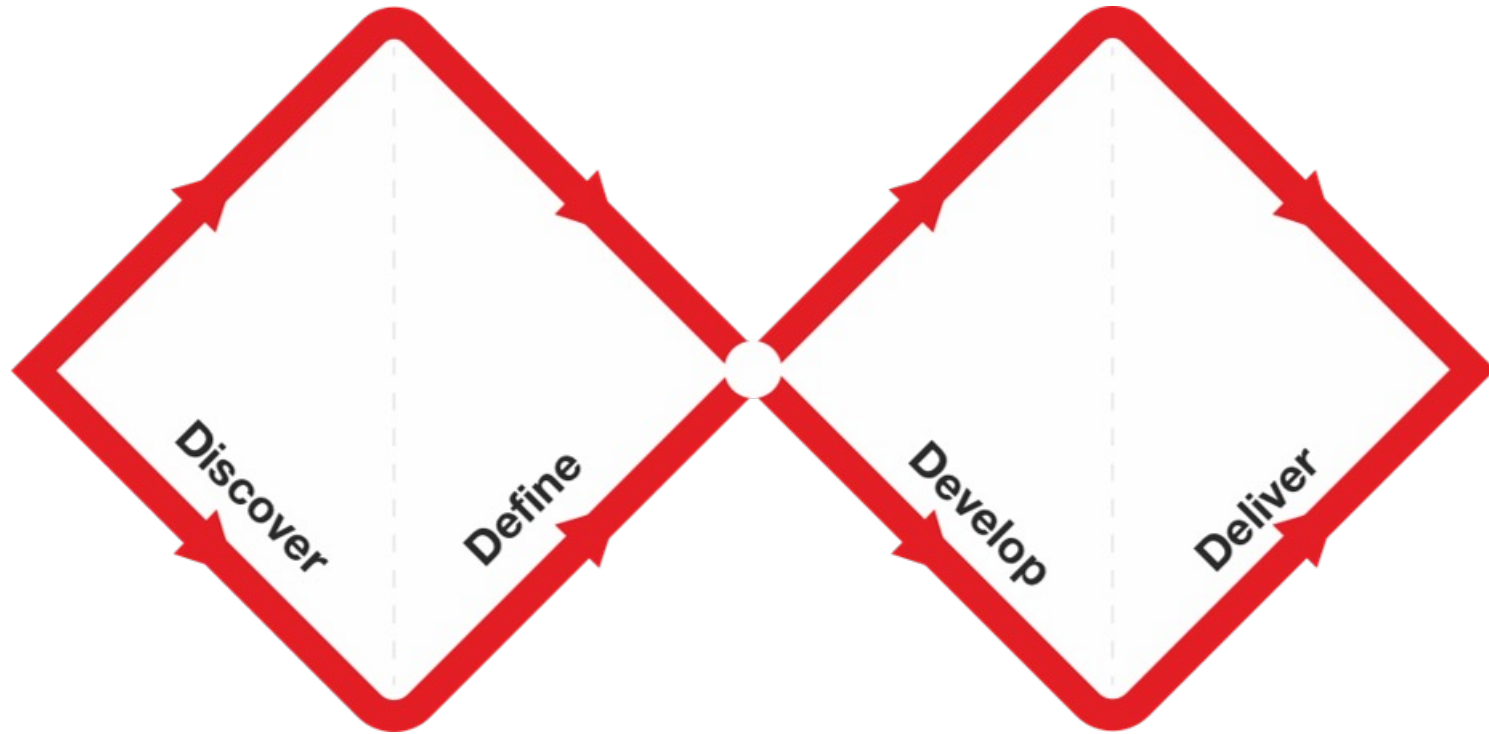
“At its core, design thinking can be construed as a creative problem-solving approach—or, more completely, as a systematic and collaborative approach for identifying and creatively solving problems.

The term design thinking simply means that one is approaching problems, and their solutions, as a designer would”.

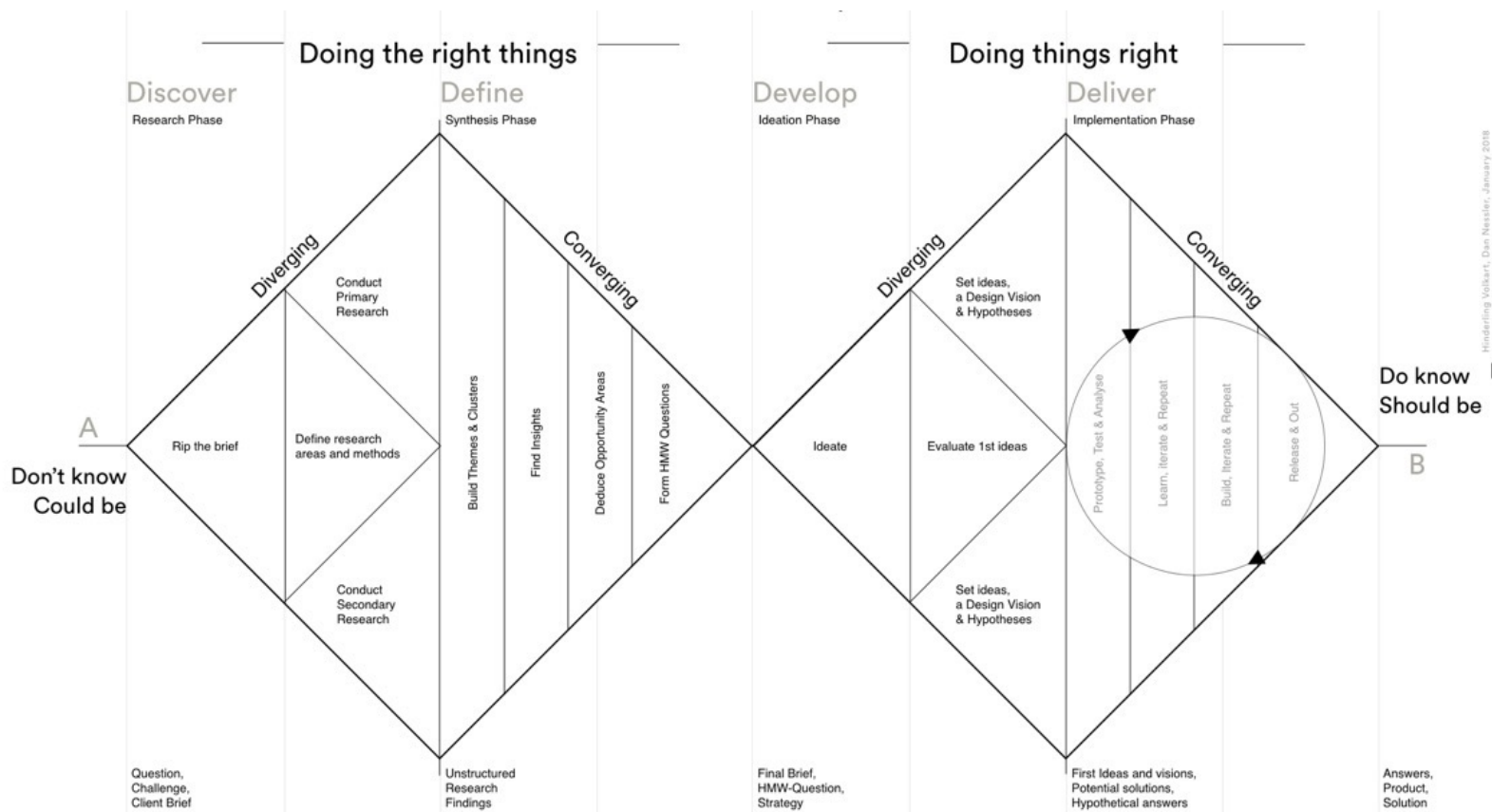
The process of design



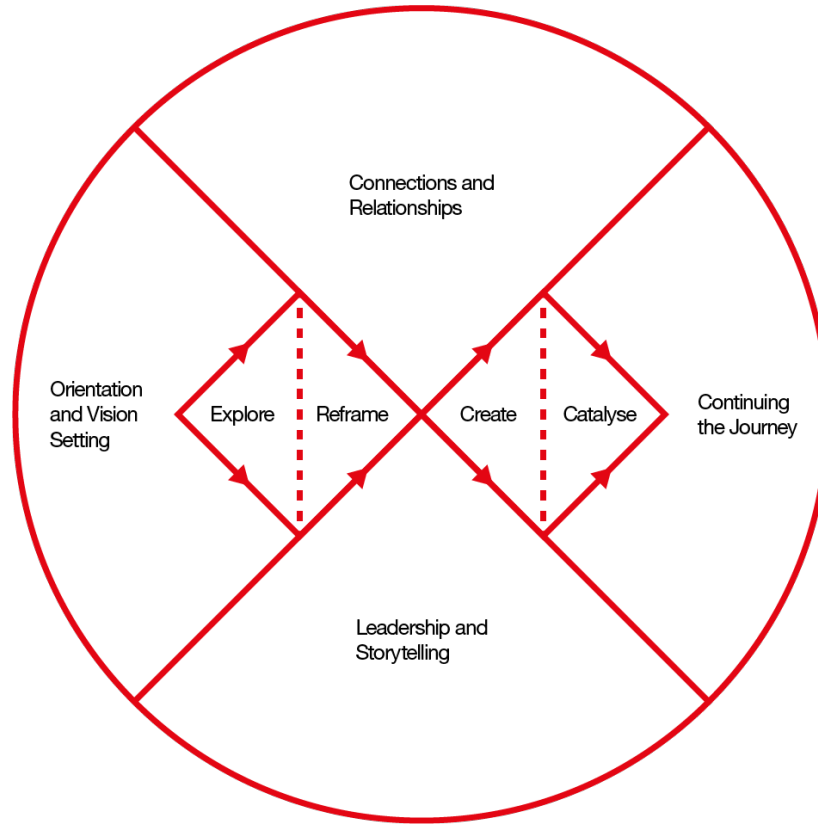
Double Diamond Design Council 2005



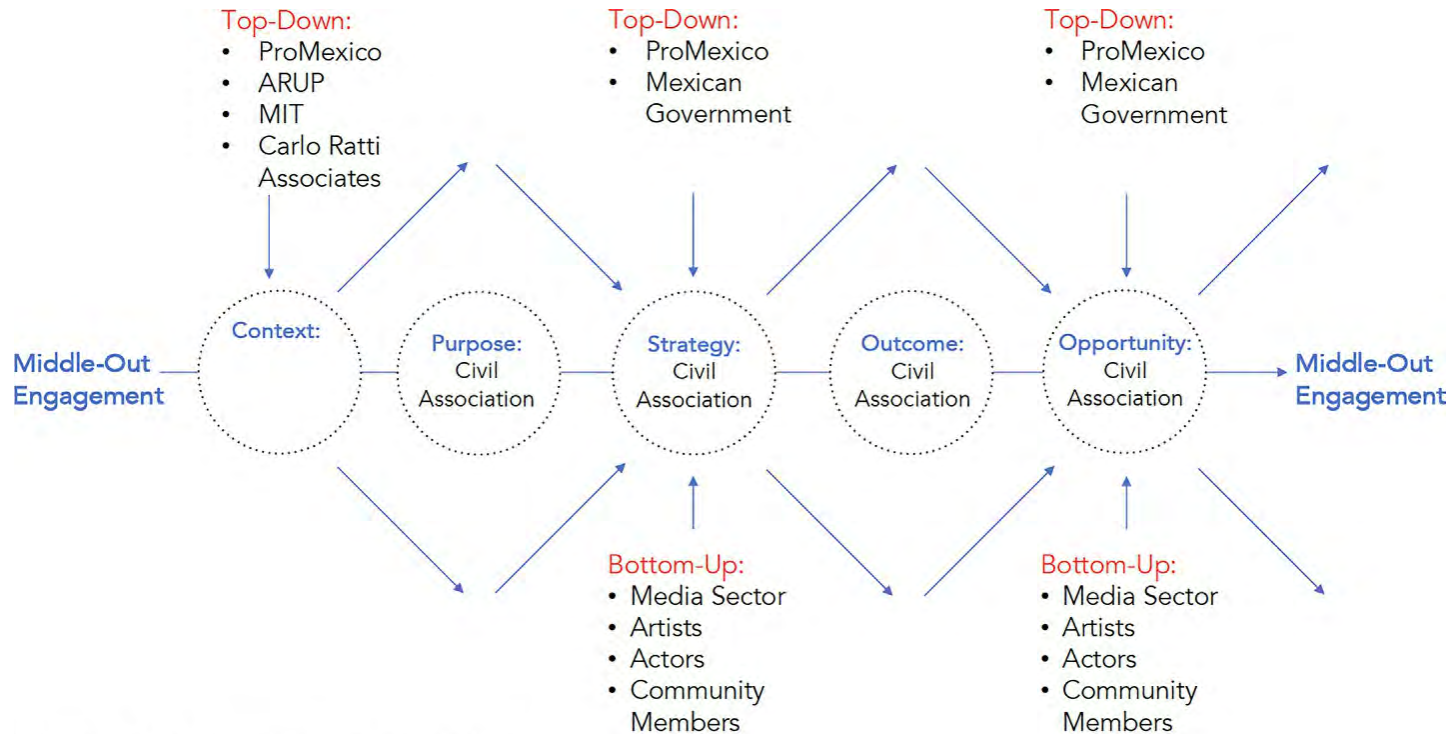
Revamped Double Diamond Nessler 2018



Systemic Design Framework Design Council 2021



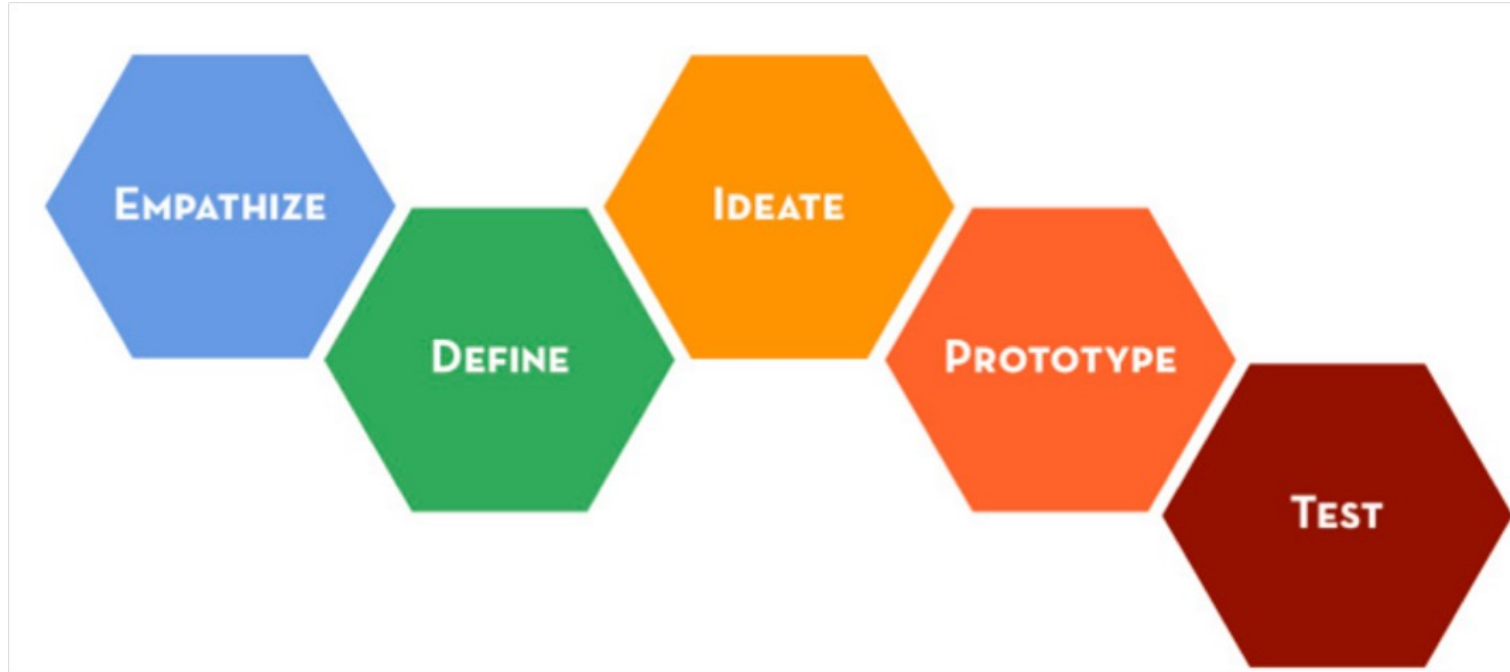
Middle-out Framework Caldwell et al. (2021)



Middle-Out Engagement: Stakeholders

FIG. 2 Middle-Out Engagement Framework stakeholders for Guadalajara. (Credit: Glenda Amayo Caldwell.)

Stanford d.school Design Thinking process



IDEO Design Thinking approach

INSPIRATION

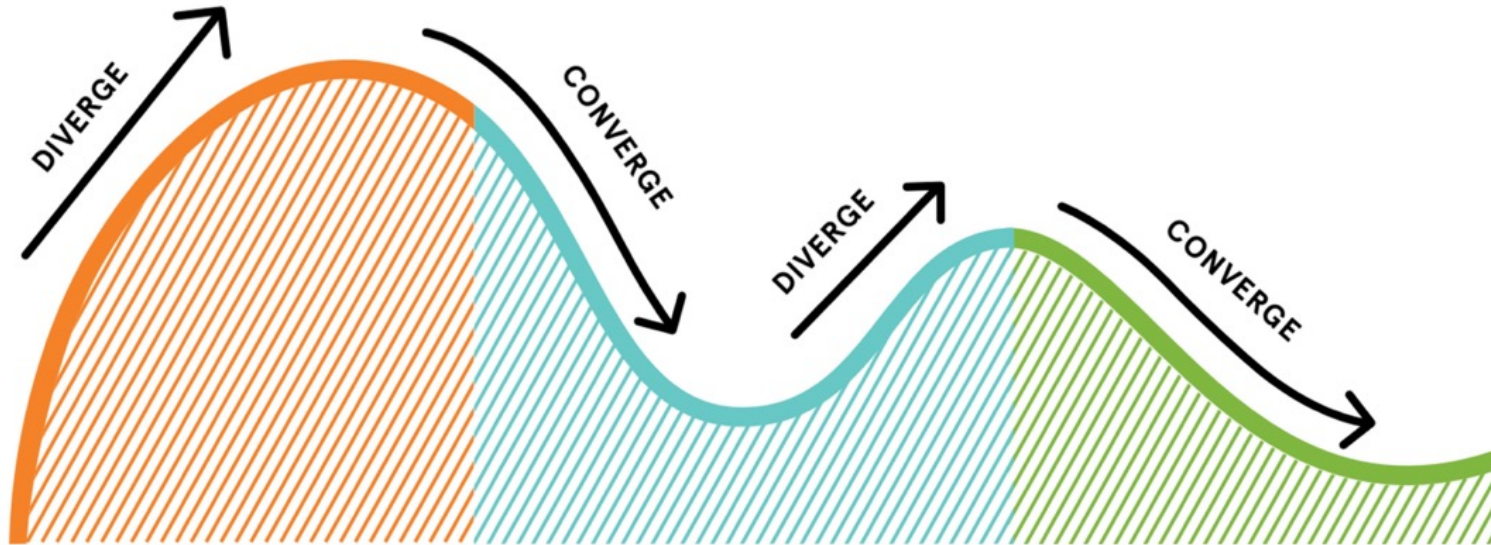
I have a design challenge.
How do I get started?
How do I conduct an interview?
How do I stay human-centered?

IDEATION

I have an opportunity for design.
How do I interpret what I've learned?
How do I turn my insights into tangible ideas?
How do I make a prototype?

IMPLEMENTATION

I have an innovative solution.
How do I make my concept real?
How do I assess if it's working?
How do I plan for sustainability?



IDEO Design Thinking steps



FRAME A QUESTION

Identify a driving question that inspires others to search for creative solutions.



GATHER INSPIRATION

Inspire new thinking by discovering what people really need.



GENERATE IDEAS

Push past obvious solutions to get to breakthrough ideas.



MAKE IDEAS TANGIBLE

Build rough prototypes to learn how to make ideas better.



TEST TO LEARN

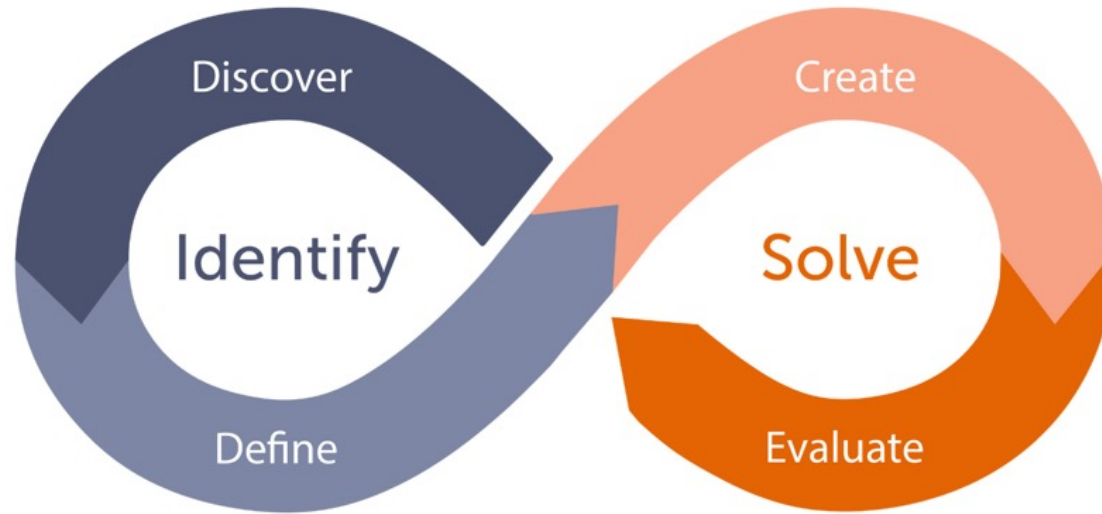
Refine ideas by gathering feedback and experimenting forward.



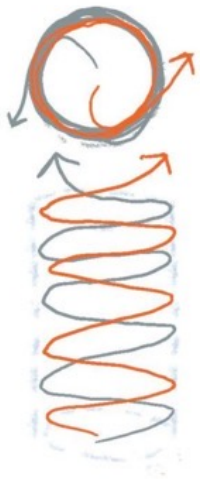
SHARE THE STORY

Craft a human story to inspire others toward action.

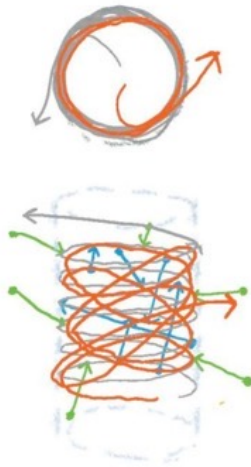
Framework for Design Thinking Luchs 2015



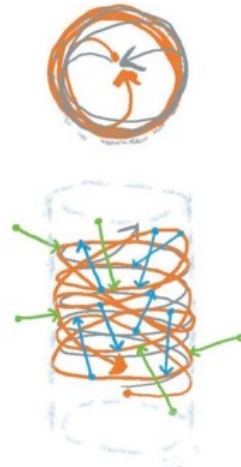
Country Network Mossman 2022



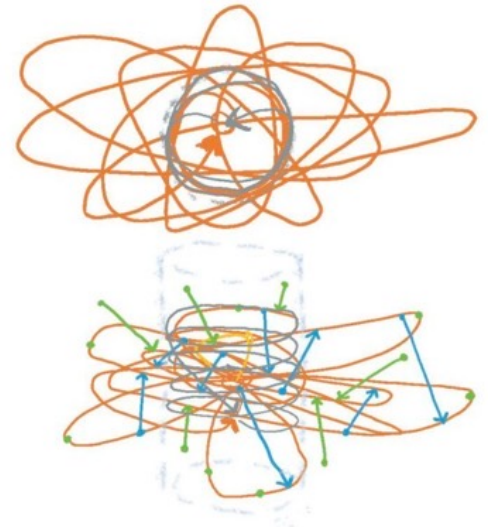
1



2

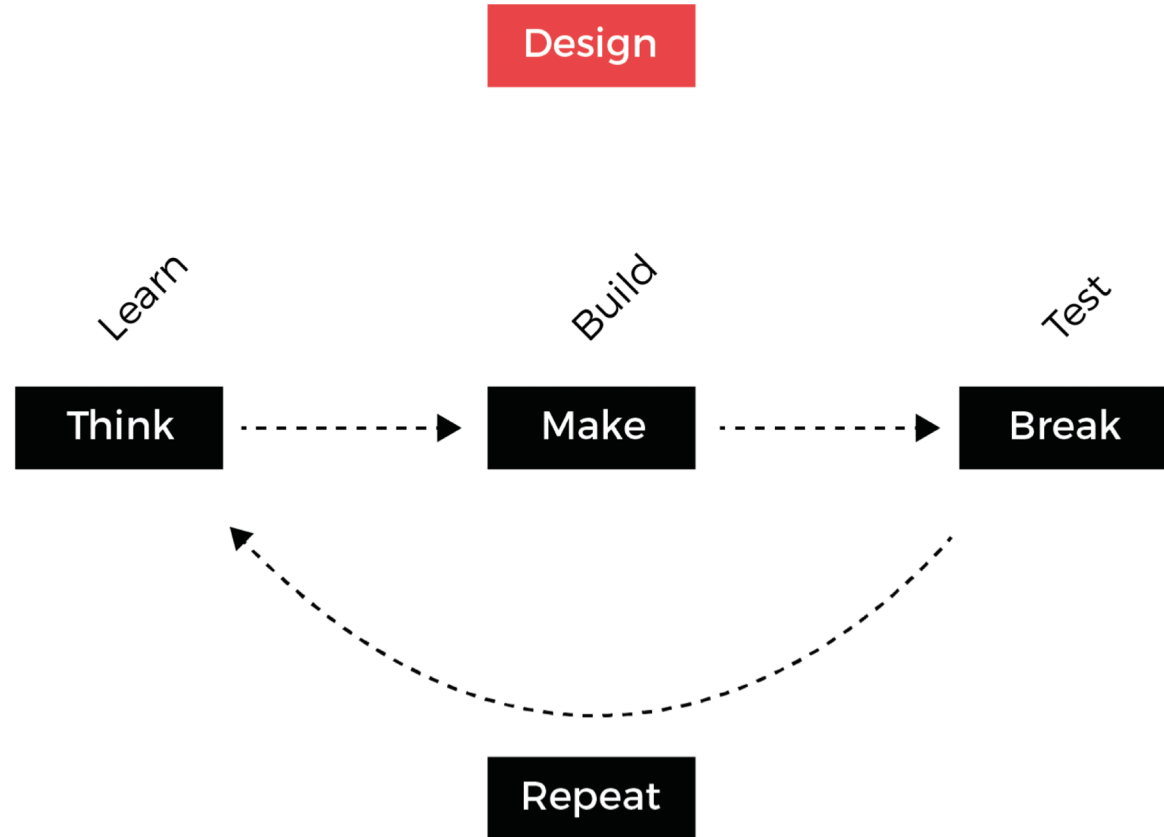
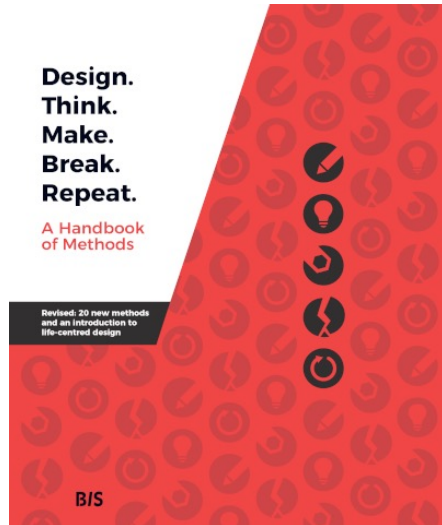


3



4

DTMBR University of Sydney

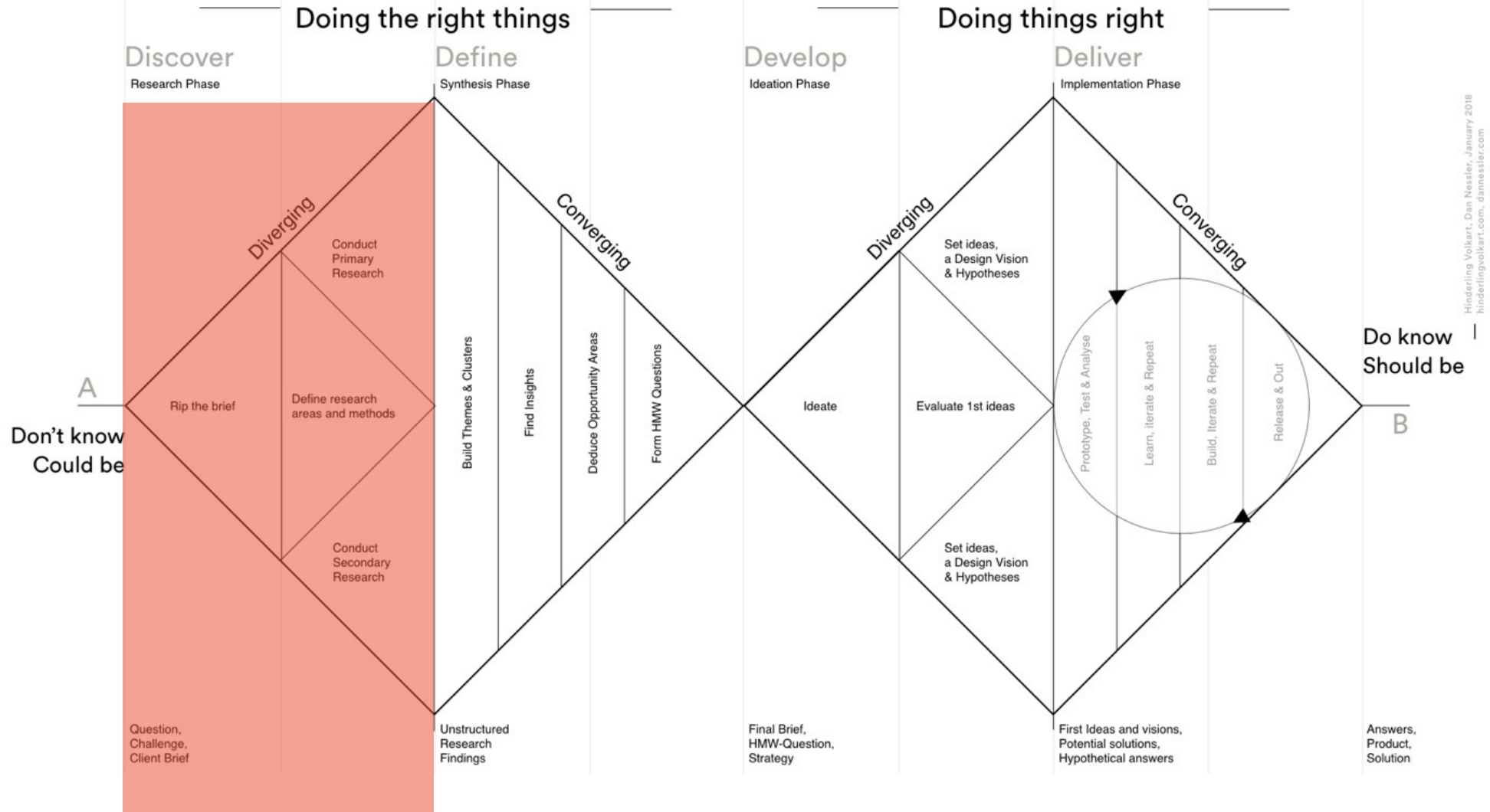


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Revamped Double Diamond

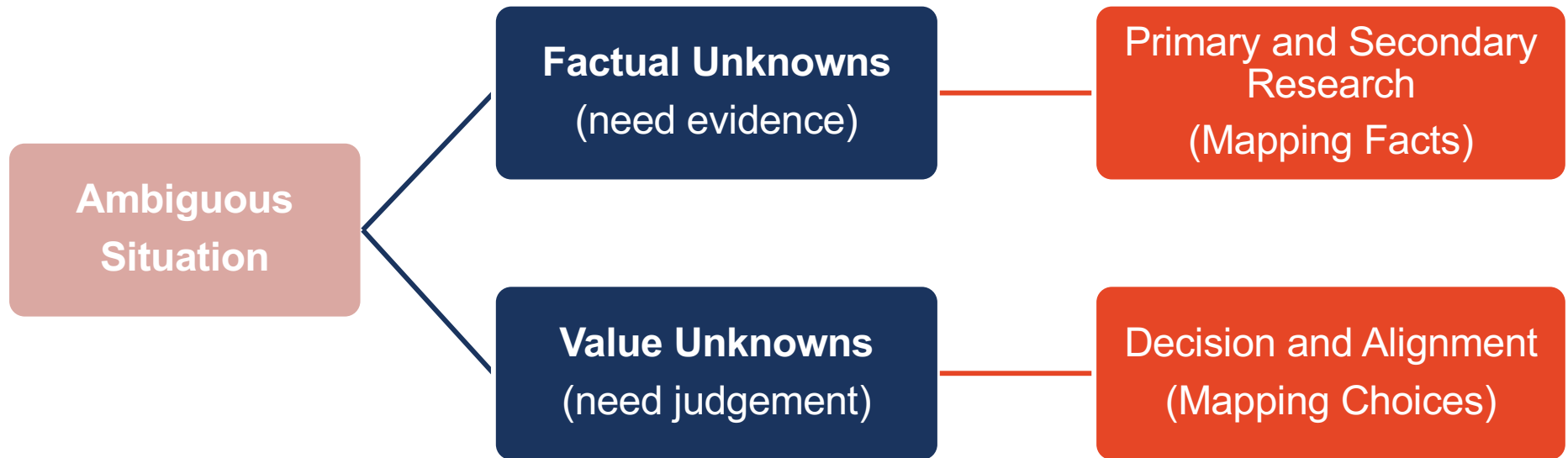


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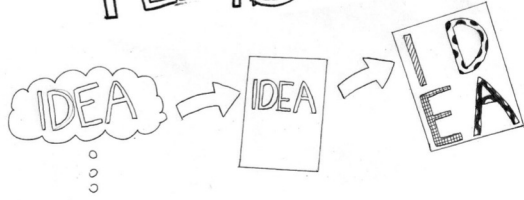
Mapping the Situation



FLEXIBILITY

Serendipity

CONCENTRATION



CONSIDER EVERY TIME YOU'VE LEFT UNFINISHED STROKES,
grayish PRELIMINARY IDEAS, QUICK SIDE QUESTIONS,
BLANK SPACES, WOBBLY LINES & FIGURES...
HAPPENS ALL THE TIME RIGHT?

Maybe
not just
on the
sides?



THE CASE FOR HAND SKETCHING

GROUP
THINKING...

HERE, LETS COLLABORATE ON
MY SUPER POLISHED IDEA

HERE, LETS WORK ON THIS
PRELIMINARY SKETCH



VS



EFFECTIVENESS

PROBLEM
SOLVING

I HAVEN'T FAILED,
I'VE FOUND
1,000 SKETCHES
THAT DON'T
WORK

Talent

EXTERNAL
memory

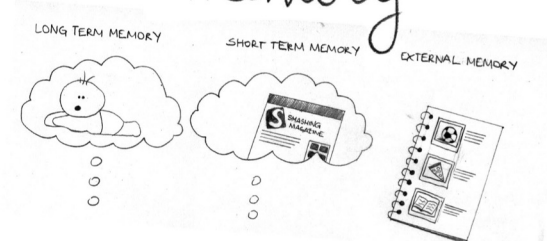
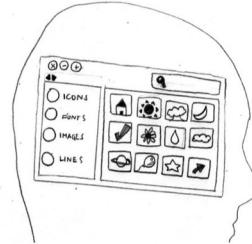
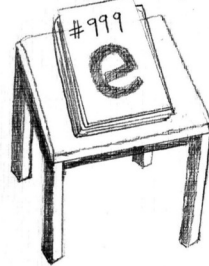
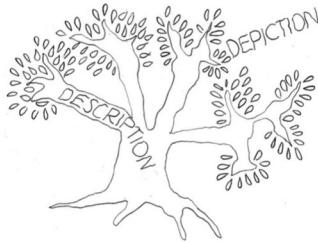
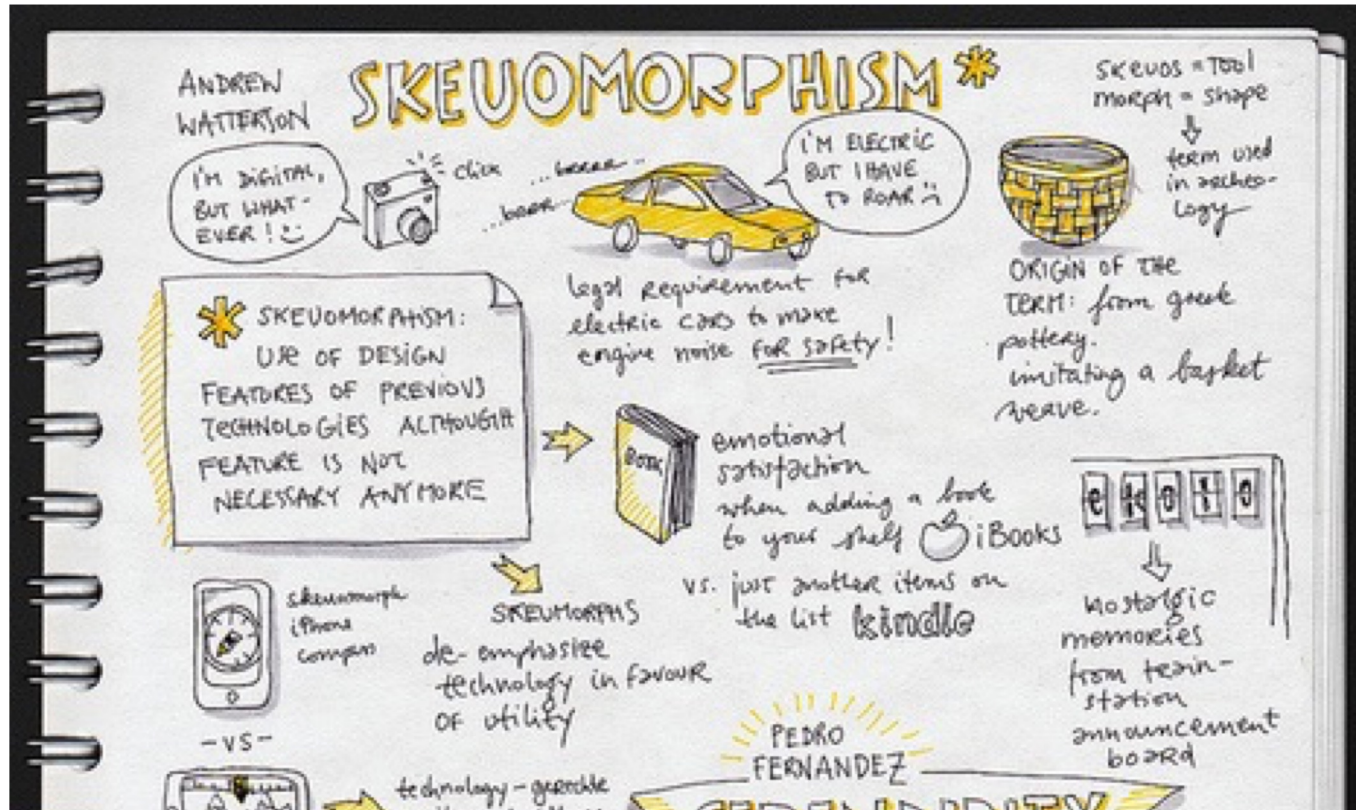


Image source: Busch, L. (2013) Smashing Magazine.

Retrieved online: <https://www.smashingmagazine.com/2013/10/things-you-can-accomplish-with-hand-sketching-doodling/>

Sketching as a research tool

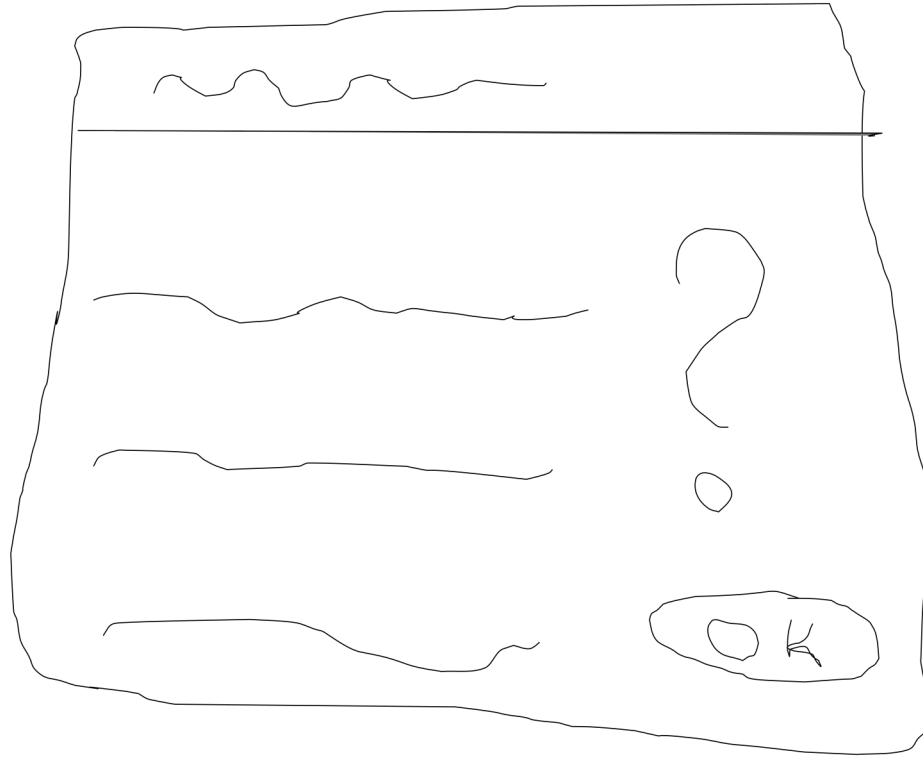


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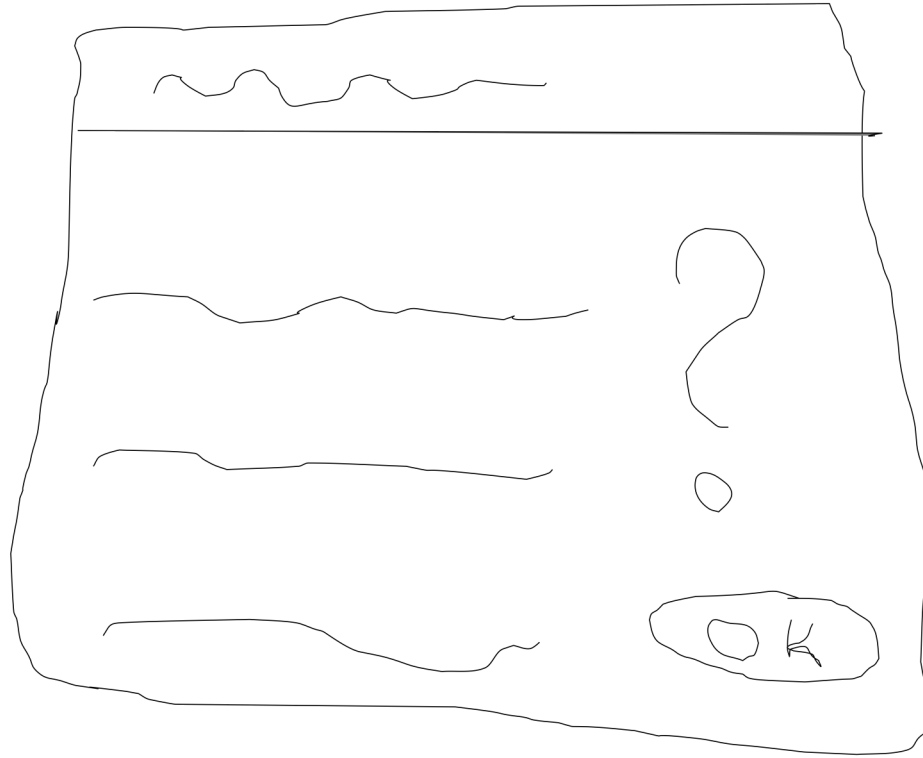
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Could you draw this?



Could you draw this? You can sketchnote!





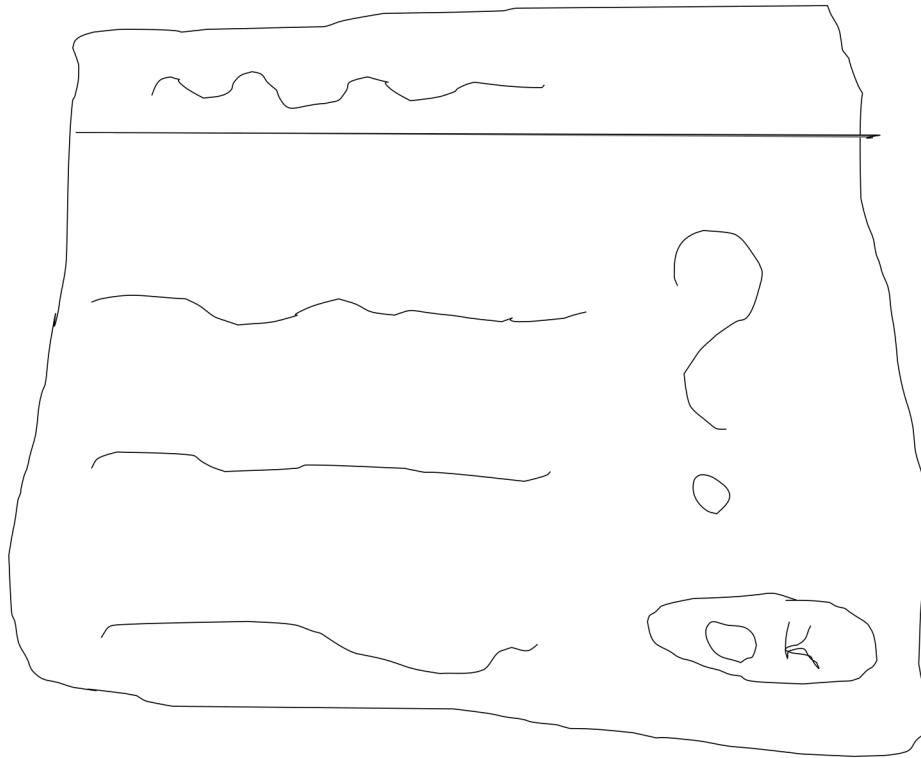
Sketchnoting

- Text in banners and frames
- Use arrows to connect ideas
- Use fonts, colours and shading to highlight information
- Use icons to help visualise ideas
- There is no wrong way!
- Anyone can sketchnote!

Let's try it and have a go!

Attributes of sketches

- Quick, to make



Attributes of sketches

- Quick
 - Timely
- Provided when needed

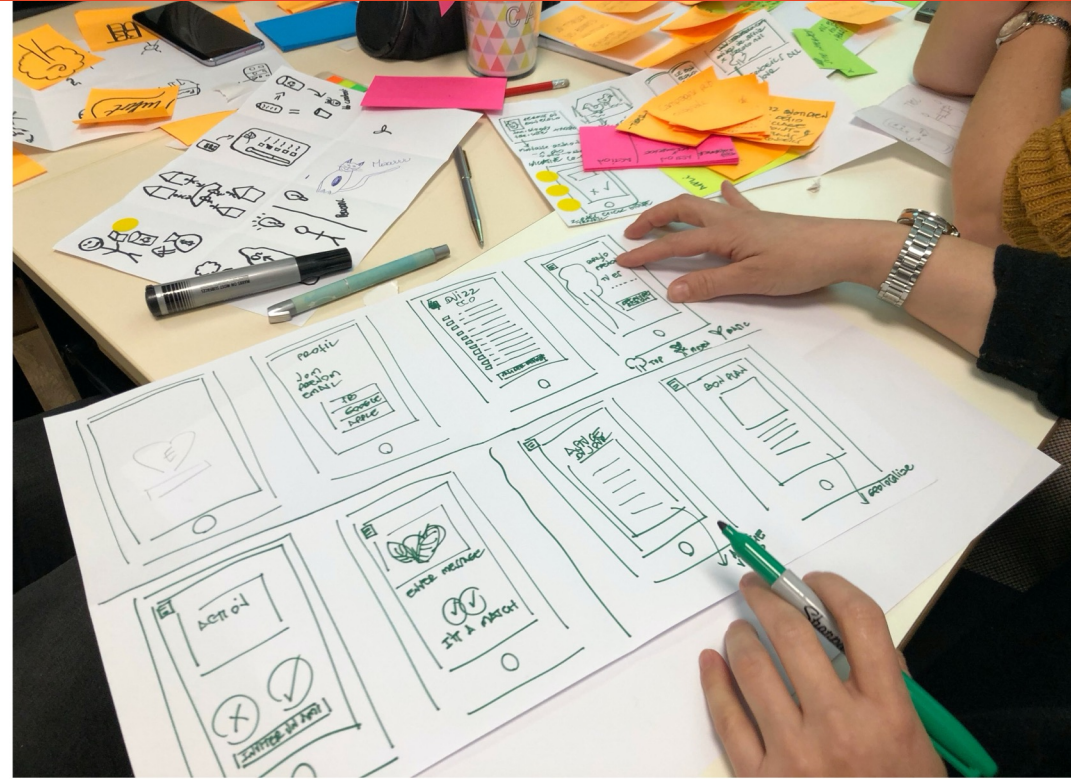


Photo by [Amélie Mourichon](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Reference: Buxton, B. (2007) Sketching User Experiences: Getting the Design Right and the Right Design. Morgan Kaufmann.

Attributes of sketches

- Quick
- Timely
- Disposable
 - a. Investment in the process and concept, not the execution
 - b. If you can't afford to throw it away, it's not a sketch



Photo by [Markus Spiske](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Attributes of sketches

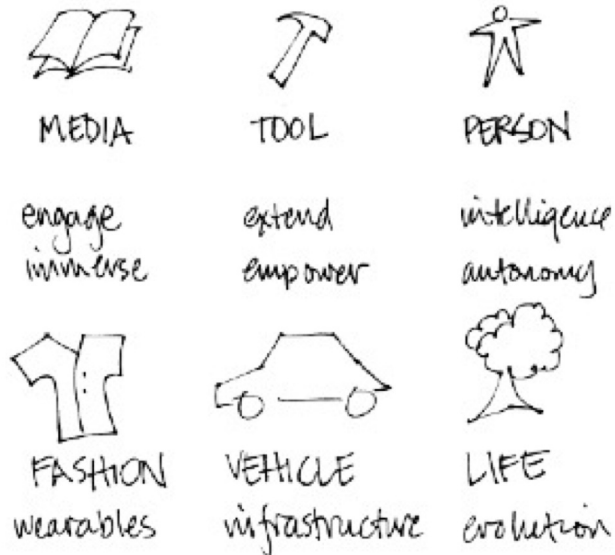
- Quick
- Timely
- Disposable
- Plentiful
 - a. Multiple sketches to explore ideas
 - b. They make sense in a collection or series of ideas



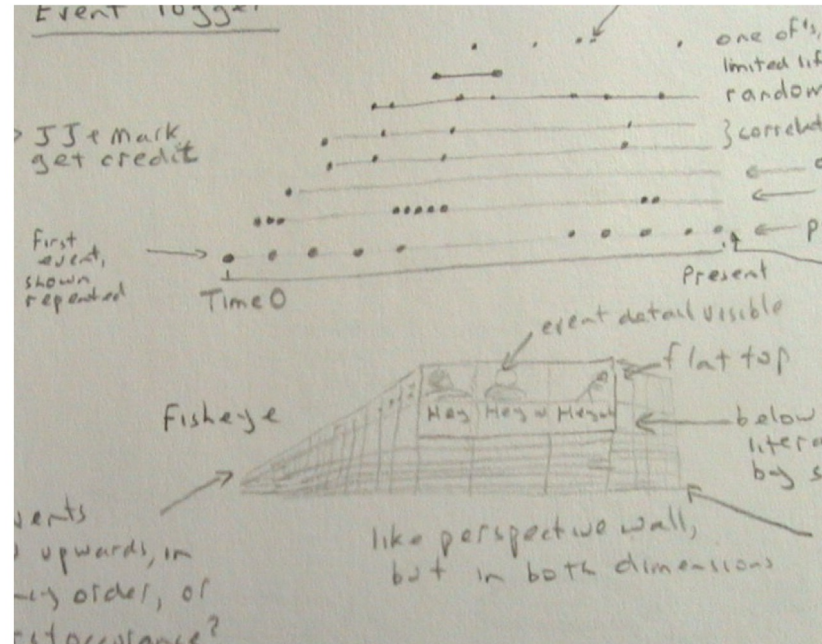
Form studies for a digital alarm clock

Image source: Baskinger, M. (2008) Pencils before Pixels.
ACM Interactions, March+April, page 32.

You don't need to be an artist



Sketched symbols from Bill Verplank

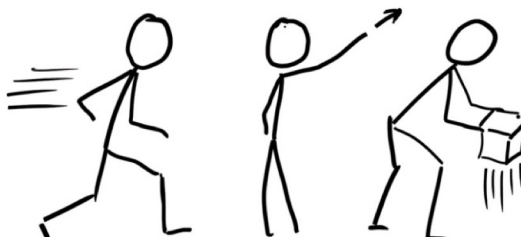
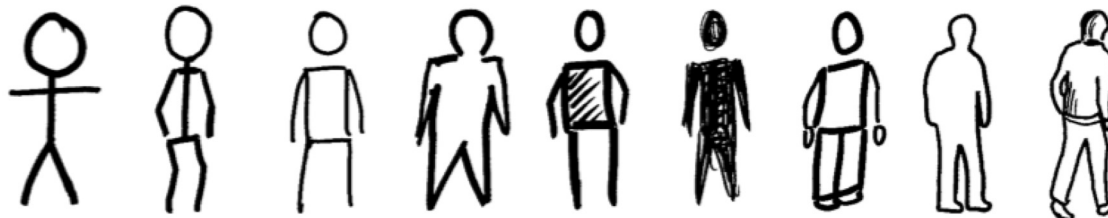


Portion of a page from Saul Greenberg's sketchbook

Reference: Buxton, B. (2007) Sketching User Experiences: Getting the Design Right and the Right Design. Morgan Kaufmann.

Image source: <http://www.billverplank.com/professional.html/1xDSketchBook.pdf>

Develop your own sketching vocabulary



Chapter 3.3, from presentations accompanying the book 'Sketching User Experiences, the Workbook', by S. Greenberg, S. Carpendale, N. Marquardt and B. Buxton

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Reminders

- You must attend your timetabled tutorials
- Please remove your name from tutorial waitlists if you are happy in your current tutorial. Otherwise, you may be moved automatically by the timetabling system.
- Project teams to be finalised in Week 3 tutorials. Changes to tutorials will not be possible after Week 3, unless approved by the unit coordinator

That's the end of today's lecture.

We'll see you in tutorials.

Find your class location here:



THE UNIVERSITY OF
SYDNEY

